

Employee Attrition: What's Driving People to Leave

A plain-language summary for HR Leadership | Prepared by: Data Analytics Intern | 30 June 2026

The Bottom Line

About 1 in 4 employees in our analysis sample left the company. That's a high enough rate to cost real money in hiring and lost productivity — but the good news is the data shows this isn't random. There are clear, fixable patterns behind who leaves and when.

What's Really Driving People Out the Door

- **Working too much overtime.** This is the single biggest warning sign. Employees who regularly work overtime leave far more often than those who don't.
- **Being paid below market for their role.** Employees who left earned about Rs. 1,723 less per month on average than those who stayed — pay matters, but it's not the whole story.
- **Being new.** Employees in their first year are roughly six times more likely to leave than employees with 10+ years of tenure. The first year is the highest-risk window by far.

Where to Focus First

The **Sales department** has the highest attrition of any department, and the **Human Resources role** has the highest attrition of any single job title in the company. These two groups should be the first stop for retention conversations.

Does Money Fix This?

Not on its own. Salary plays a real role, but overtime habits and how supported new hires feel in their first year matter just as much — sometimes more. A pay-only fix will likely under-deliver.

Two Things We Recommend Doing Now

1. **Put a cap on chronic overtime** and set up a manager check-in for anyone working extended hours for three months or more, starting with Sales and HR teams.
2. **Launch structured 90-day and 1-year "stay interviews"** for new hires. Since most departures happen in year one, an early, proactive conversation is likely to have the biggest payoff per dollar spent.

One Important Caveat

This analysis is based on historical patterns and survey data — it can't see personal circumstances, a person's relationship with their manager, or what's happening in the outside job market. Use it to decide **who to talk to**, not as the final word on any individual employee decision.

Based on analysis of 1,470 employee records. Full technical methodology, model comparison, and supporting charts are available in the accompanying Jupyter notebook ([analysis.ipynb](#)).